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It angers me when kids want to play IPL and not for India: Kapil



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Kapil Dev belongs to a generation when the T20 cricket league was an alien concept, but as the game has progressed with the shorter format dominating it, he is happy to see the amount of talent that has emerged.

"Don't you feel good when teams score 300 runs in T20I? I feel very good because it shows the amount of talent we have. In our time, we struggled to score 100 runs in 50 overs. So, you have to admire this generation," Kapil said at the PlayCom 2025: Business of Sports Summit.

In a fireside chat with Suresh Balakrishna, the Chief Revenue Officer of *The Hindu Group*, Kapil admitted that while it is heartwarming to see parents encouraging their wards to take up sports, it angers him when people want to play in the IPL and not for the country.

"The change is that now the parents want their kids to play cricket, whereas in our time, playing cricket meant parents would slap you. Now parents bring their wards to the ground with the hope that their child can play in the IPL. It angers me when you want to play the IPL and not for the country. That's when I get annoyed. The aim should be to represent the country, and not the club," he said.

At the same time, Kapil underlined the importance of building credibility in the larger sporting ecosystem, especially in its dealings with corporates. "You have to approach the corporate world with humility

when asking for money. If you take ₹100 from them, you must deliver value worth ₹1,000. That's when it works. But if you take ₹100 and give back only ₹10 in value, it won't work — whether it's golf, basketball, or any sport," he cautioned.

However, he isn't against former players featuring in franchise league cricket abroad. "After playing, they have to look after themselves. And if they think they can make a better life by playing in the leagues, that's fine," Kapil said.

While the BCCI does not allow its players to feature in any franchise leagues, except for the IPL, the retired players are permitted to feature in overseas leagues. And, Kapil sees nothing wrong in that. "We should never raise our fingers, because either you give them a guarantee that they will be looked after leaving cricket. The fact is, we don't look after anyone," the 1983 World Cup-winning captain said.

